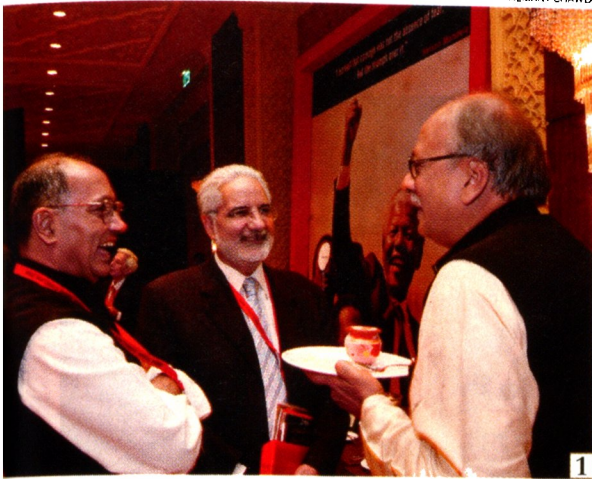




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JATIN

COMMON INTERESTS: 1. Digvijay Singh, I.S. Bindra, Nikhil Kumar; 2. Rekha Purie, Modi; 3. Bajaj, TVS Chairman Venu Srinivasan; 4. Prabhu Chawla, Chidambaram, Kidwai; 5. Aroon Purie and Gore raise a toast; 6. Craig Venter with Hearst's Kim St. Clair Bodden

after Gore's speech and just before the champagne glasses made the rounds but not before exchanging notes on managing money with HSBC Country Head Naina Lal Kidwai. Ribbed about the Union Budget on an all-woman table, he smiled gently and asked, "But why are women complaining? I have just increased your tax deduction to Rs 1,80,000." Hollywood producer Ashok Amritraj raced through his dinner to catch a flight to Bangkok where he is wrapping up shooting on *The Other End of the Line*, but not before he, Zinta and Shekhar Kapur had an hour-long tête-à-tête in the hotel tea lounge, undeterred by curious passers-by and eager autograph-seekers. Aamir had plenty of them every time he went back and forth to his room, where he had to catch up on his daily four-hour regimen of 1,000 abdominal crunches, weight-training and cardio for his new film, a remake of the Tamil film *Ghajini*. The producer of his most recent blockbuster PVR Pictures' *Ajay Bijli* made a rare

appearance with his wife Celina. If former Samata Party chief Jaya Jaitly discussed umpiring with Australian cricket writer Peter Roebuck, it was no surprise. She is after all cricketer Ajay Jadeja's mother-in-law. Roebuck took in as many sessions as he could, declaring himself most impressed by Congress MP Sachin Pilot's thoughts during the youth debate. If Rahul Bajaj of Bajaj Auto looked at home, again it was no surprise. He has a permanent room at the hotel for his MP duty, Room 141.

A day earlier, Gujarat Chief Minister Narendra Modi was the focus of attention as his sparring partner, former chief minister Digvijay Singh, modestly answered questions on who would win elections in Madhya Pradesh. Gilchrist survived a marathon media session with his trademark smile in place, but not before he had nicked a few pages off an autograph hunter's notebook to scribble notes during Ambani's speech.

Farooq Abdullah, having excited much laughter from the